



Foundations: Start in the Browser

40 MCQs – Beginner (10) · Intermediate (10) · Expert (10) · Ultra (10)

Based on [The AI Agent Factory Foundations](#)



Beginner Level

Q1. According to the Foundations overview, how many courses are in the Foundations section?

- A. A) 4
- B. B) 5
- C. C) 6
- D. D) 7

✓ **Correct Answer: C) 6**

Explanation: The Foundations section consists of six courses that build on each other: What AI Actually Is, AI Prompting, Markdown In HTML Out, Code You Never Write, Skills & Connectors, and How to Think in the AI Era.

Q2. Where does the Foundations course say you should learn all six skills?

- A. A) In a classroom
- B. B) In a browser tab
- C. C) In a mobile app
- D. D) In a terminal

✓ **Correct Answer: B) In a browser tab**

Explanation: The course emphasizes learning all six skills “right in a browser tab” using Claude.ai, ChatGPT, or Gemini — nothing to install and no risk to your computer.

Q3. What is the first course you should read among the six Foundations courses?

- A. A) AI Prompting in 2026
- B. B) Markdown In, HTML Out
- C. C) What AI Actually Is
- D. D) How to Think in the AI Era

✓ Correct Answer: C) What AI Actually Is

Explanation: The “What AI Actually Is” course is explicitly described as “the one to read before the others, even though it is the most abstract.”

Q4. According to the Foundations, what is the relationship between the six courses?

- A. A) They are independent and can be taken in any order
- B. B) They build on each other
- C. C) They are all optional
- D. D) They cover the same topic from different angles

✓ Correct Answer: B) They build on each other

Explanation: The overview states “The six build on each other,” indicating a progressive learning structure.

Q5. What does the analogy of “driving a car without knowing what an engine is” illustrate in the What AI Actually Is course?

- A. A) That AI is too complex to understand
- B. B) That most people use AI without understanding how it works
- C. C) That you need to be a mechanic to use AI
- D. D) That cars are better than AI

✓ Correct Answer: B) That most people use AI without understanding how it works

Explanation: The analogy explains that most people have learned to “drive” AI (use it) but have never looked under the hood to understand what it actually is.

Q6. What is the primary difference between how novice users and power users interact with AI, according to the Prompting course?

- A. A) Novices use better tools

- B. B) Power users brief AI like a smart-but-new colleague with files, context, and constraints
- C. C) Novices have better internet connections
- D. D) Power users write code

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Power users brief AI like a smart-but-new colleague with files, context, and constraints**

Explanation: The course states that power users “brief AI the way they would brief a smart-but-new colleague: with files, context, constraints, and a clear ask.”

Q7. What is Markdown described as in the Markdown In, HTML Out course?

- A. A) A programming language
- B. B) Plain text with a few extra marks that show structure
- C. C) A type of software
- D. D) An AI model

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Plain text with a few extra marks that show structure**

Explanation: Markdown is defined as “plain text with a few extra marks that show structure: a # before a heading, a - before each item in a list.”

Q8. In the Code You Never Write course, what does the bookkeeper example demonstrate?

- A. A) That bookkeepers need to learn programming
- B. B) That AI can write and run code to solve real work problems without the user writing a single line
- C. C) That accounting is outdated
- D. D) That AI cannot handle spreadsheets

✓ **Correct Answer: B) That AI can write and run code to solve real work problems without the user writing a single line**

Explanation: The bookkeeper described a problem in plain English, the AI wrote the code and ran it, and the work that used to take an evening finished in minutes

— without her ever writing a line of code.

Q9. What is a “Skill” in the Skills & Connectors course?

- A. A) A programming language
- B. B) A way to teach AI a task once and have it do that task your way every time
- C. C) A type of connector
- D. D) An AI model

✓ **Correct Answer: B) A way to teach AI a task once and have it do that task your way every time**

Explanation: A Skill is defined as teaching AI a task once so it can do that task your way every time without re-explaining.

Q10. According to the How to Think in the AI Era course, what is “the deliverable”?

- A. A) The AI’s answer
- B. B) The documented evidence of thinking
- C. C) The final report
- D. D) The prompt you wrote

✓ **Correct Answer: B) The documented evidence of thinking**

Explanation: The course states: “The deliverable is never the answer. The deliverable is the documented evidence of thinking.”



Intermediate Level

Q11. What fundamental fact about AI underlies everything in the Prompting course?

- A. A) AI has perfect memory
- B. B) The model is stateless — it has no memory of its own between turns
- C. C) AI always gives correct answers
- D. D) AI cannot process images

✓ **Correct Answer: B) The model is stateless — it has no memory of its own between turns**

Explanation: The course states: “the model is stateless — it has no memory of its own between turns, and answers each time using only what is in its context window right now.”

Q12. What are the two moves that almost every “advanced technique” in prompting reduces to?

- A. A) Writing longer prompts and using more emojis
- B. B) Getting the right context in, or keeping the wrong context out
- C. C) Using ChatGPT instead of Claude
- D. D) Adding more questions

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Getting the right context in, or keeping the wrong context out**

Explanation: The course explains that “almost every ‘advanced technique’ on this page is one of two moves — getting the right context in, or keeping the wrong context out.”

Q13. How much did context windows grow from 2022 to 2026, according to the Prompting course?

- A. A) 10x

- B. B) 100x
- C. C) Roughly 1000x
- D. D) 10,000x

✓ **Correct Answer: C) Roughly 1000x**

Explanation: "Context windows grew by roughly 1000x. A 2022 model held a few thousand words. A 2026 model holds hundreds of thousands, sometimes a million."

Q14. According to the Markdown In, HTML Out course, what question settles every format decision?

- A. A) What is the cheapest option?
- B. B) Who reads this last?
- C. C) How long should it be?
- D. D) What color should it be?

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Who reads this last?**

Explanation: The course states: "Behind the picture sits one question, and it settles every format decision in this course: who reads this last?"

Q15. What does the Markdown In, HTML Out course recommend when a person will read something in a browser?

- A. A) Use plain text
- B. B) Ask for HTML
- C. C) Use Markdown
- D. D) Use PDF

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Ask for HTML**

Explanation: "If a person will read it in a browser, ask for HTML. If an AI will read it, or you will feed it back to an AI later, keep it in Markdown."

Q16. What are “artifacts” (called Canvas in ChatGPT and Gemini) in the context of the Markdown course?

- A. A) Errors in the code
- B. B) Live documents the AI builds next to the conversation
- C. C) Programming languages
- D. D) AI models

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Live documents the AI builds next to the conversation**

Explanation: “That panel is an artifact: a live document the AI builds next to the conversation instead of inside it. (ChatGPT and Gemini call theirs Canvas; same idea.)”

Q17. What is the “one sentence” that holds the whole Code You Never Write course?

- A. A) “Learn to code or be left behind”
- B. B) “You are not learning to write code; you are learning to be a manager/commissioner of code”
- C. C) “Python is the best language”
- D. D) “Always check the code yourself”

✓ **Correct Answer: B) You are not learning to write code; you are learning to be a manager/commissioner of code**

Explanation: “One sentence holds the whole course: you are not learning to write code; you are learning to be a [manager of code].”

Q18. According to the Skills & Connectors course, what is a Connector?

- A. A) A programming tool
- B. B) A way to give AI safe access to your real apps and data
- C. C) A type of Skill
- D. D) An AI model

✓ **Correct Answer: B) A way to give AI safe access to your real apps and data**

Explanation: "A Connector gives AI hands to reach your real apps and data." The course also explains that with connectors, AI stops asking you to copy-paste and starts reaching for things itself.

Q19. What is the relationship between a chat message, a Skill, and a Connector according to the kitchen analogy?

- A. A) They are all the same thing
- B. B) A chat message is a one-time order; a Skill teaches how to do something every time; a Connector gives hands to reach apps and data
- C. C) Skills are more important than connectors
- D. D) Chat messages are obsolete

✓ Correct Answer: B) A chat message is a one-time order; a Skill teaches how to do something every time; a Connector gives hands to reach apps and data

Explanation: The kitchen analogy explains: "A one-time chat message is an order shouted across the counter: 'make me a sandwich.' It gets made once and forgotten." A Skill teaches how to do something every time; a Connector gives hands to reach real apps and data.

Q20. What does Person A do differently from Person B in the opening example of the How to Think in the AI Era course?

- A. A) Person A uses better AI tools
- B. B) Person A forms her own opinion before asking AI and documents her reasoning
- C. C) Person A spends more time
- D. D) Person A has more experience

✓ Correct Answer: B) Person A forms her own opinion before asking AI and documents her reasoning

Explanation: "Person A formed her own opinion before asking AI. Person B let AI's first answer become her opinion. That gap is what this crash course closes."



Expert Level

Q21. According to the What AI Actually Is course, how does understanding what AI is change your relationship with it when it does something strange?

- A. A) You can fix the AI yourself
- B. B) The failures stop being mysteries and start being predictable
- C. C) You can write better code
- D. D) You can build your own AI

✓ **Correct Answer: B) The failures stop being mysteries and start being predictable**

Explanation: The course explains that understanding the nine ideas “explain every surprising thing AI does, so that the failures stop being mysteries and start being predictable. Once you can predict the failures, you can avoid them.”

Q22. What is the relationship between the What AI Actually Is course and the Prompting course regarding topics like context window and confidence?

- A. A) They cover the same topics identically
- B. B) What AI Actually Is gives the mechanism; Prompting gives the practice/habits
- C. C) They contradict each other
- D. D) Prompting covers everything; What AI Actually Is is optional

✓ **Correct Answer: B) What AI Actually Is gives the mechanism; Prompting gives the practice/habits**

Explanation: The course explains: “This course gives the mechanism (one explanation, then it moves on); the prompting course gives the practice (the habits, in depth).” The table shows how topics are split — e.g., context window: here it’s “why it’s the only thing the model sees”; in Prompting it’s “how to manage and protect it.”

Q23. What does the Prompting course mean when it says “a year ago, the hardest task AI could reliably finish was something that would have taken a person a few minutes. Today it is something that would have taken a person an hour or more”?

- A. A) AI has become 10x slower
- B. B) AI can now handle significantly more complex, longer-duration tasks than before
- C. C) People have become slower
- D. D) Tasks have become easier

✓ Correct Answer: B) AI can now handle significantly more complex, longer-duration tasks than before

Explanation: This statement highlights the dramatic capability improvement of AI, showing that tasks which took minutes a year ago have scaled to tasks taking an hour or more — representing roughly a 10-60x increase in the complexity of tasks AI can reliably complete.

Q24. In the Markdown In, HTML Out course, what is the significance of the two-minute exercise (asking for a welcome card HTML artifact)?

- A. A) It shows that HTML is better than Markdown
- B. B) It demonstrates the entire course’s concept once, by accident, in two minutes
- C. C) It proves Claude is better than ChatGPT
- D. D) It is a waste of time

✓ Correct Answer: B) It demonstrates the entire course’s concept once, by accident, in two minutes

Explanation: “Two minutes, and you have already done everything this course teaches, once, by accident: a few structured lines went in, a designed page came out, and a link made it shareable.”

Q25. What does the Code You Never Write course identify as “the skill this course is really about”?

- A. A) Learning Python syntax
- B. B) Trusting work you cannot see
- C. C) Writing efficient algorithms
- D. D) Debugging code

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Trusting work you cannot see**

Explanation: “That last part, trusting work you cannot see, is the skill this course is really about.” The course emphasizes verifying work you cannot read.

Q26. According to the Code You Never Write course, what kinds of problems are suitable for AI to solve with code?

- A. A) Only programming problems
- B. B) The unglamorous chores that quietly eat whole days in real work — mismatched spreadsheets, grades, logs, files
- C. C) Only mathematical problems
- D. D) Only creative writing

✓ **Correct Answer: B) The unglamorous chores that quietly eat whole days in real work — mismatched spreadsheets, grades, logs, files**

Explanation: The course describes code’s purpose as “the unglamorous chores that quietly eat whole days in real work, the kind with real stakes: a grade, a paycheck, a patient’s record, a client’s money.” Examples include accountants, doctors, marketers, teachers, and students.

Q27. In the Skills & Connectors course, what is the significance of the statement “teach AI a task once and have it do that task your way, every time, without re-explaining”?

- A. A) It’s a nice-to-have but not essential
- B. B) It represents the fundamental shift from using AI like a vending machine to working with it like a coworker
- C. C) It only works for programmers
- D. D) It’s impossible to achieve

✓ **Correct Answer: B) It represents the fundamental shift from using AI like a vending machine to working with it like a coworker**

Explanation: The course contrasts the “vending machine” approach (typing the same request every time) with the Skills approach: “You can teach AI a task once and have it do that task your way, every time, without re-explaining.”

Q28. According to the Skills & Connectors course, what is the current free-tier limit for custom connectors (as of June 2026)?

- A. A) Unlimited
- B. B) One custom connector
- C. C) Five custom connectors
- D. D) Zero

✓ **Correct Answer: B) One custom connector**

Explanation: The course notes: “A few details here are point-in-time and will drift: menu paths, free-plan limits (today, one custom connector on the free tier).”

Q29. What warning does the How to Think in the AI Era course give about AI models’ feedback on practice exercises?

- A. A) All AI models give perfect feedback
- B. B) Older or weaker models tend to give vague or overly positive feedback regardless of what you submit
- C. C) Only Claude can grade properly
- D. D) Feedback is always accurate

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Older or weaker models tend to give vague or overly positive feedback regardless of what you submit**

Explanation: “Older or weaker models tend to give vague or overly positive feedback regardless of what you submit. Use the best model you have access to.”

Q30. According to the How to Think in the AI Era course, what did a dean at IE School of Science & Technology say about the real danger of AI in schools?

- A. A) That AI will replace teachers
- B. B) That students stop building the mental muscle that writing summaries was always meant to build
- C. C) That AI writes better than students
- D. D) That schools should ban AI

✓ Correct Answer: B) That students stop building the mental muscle that writing summaries was always meant to build

Explanation: “The real danger of AI in school is not that it writes a worse summary — it is that students stop building the mental muscle that writing summaries was always meant to build.”

Ultra Level

Q31. What does the What AI Actually Is course mean when it says AI “is stateless” and what are the practical implications?

- A. A) AI has no memory between turns and answers using only what’s in its context window — this is why you must provide context every time
- B. B) AI is always in a state of confusion
- C. C) AI cannot learn anything
- D. D) AI remembers everything forever

✓ Correct Answer: A) AI has no memory between turns and answers using only what’s in its context window — this is why you must provide context every time

Explanation: The statelessness concept is central to the Prompting course: “the model is stateless — it has no memory of its own between turns, and answers each time using only what is in its context window right now.” This explains why “almost every ‘advanced technique’ ... is one of two moves — getting the right context in, or keeping the wrong context out.”

Q32. How does the What AI Actually Is course characterize the relationship between understanding AI’s mechanisms and avoiding over-trust or distrust?

- A. A) Both over-trust and distrust come from the same place: not knowing what the thing actually is
- B. B) Over-trust is from ignorance; distrust is from knowledge
- C. C) Neither can be avoided
- D. D) Only experts can avoid both

✓ Correct Answer: A) Both over-trust and distrust come from the same place: not knowing what the thing actually is

Explanation: “When the machine does something strange... they have no model for why, and they either over-trust it or write it off. Both reactions come from the same place: not knowing what the thing actually is.”

Q33. The Prompting course states that “almost every ‘advanced technique’ on this page is one of two moves.” What deeper insight does this reveal about AI prompting as a discipline?

- A. A) Prompting is just about writing longer prompts
- B. B) Effective prompting fundamentally reduces to context management — controlling what enters and stays out of the context window
- C. C) Advanced techniques are just marketing
- D. D) Prompting is purely about creativity

✓ Correct Answer: B) Effective prompting fundamentally reduces to context management — controlling what enters and stays out of the context window

Explanation: This insight reveals that all prompting techniques are variations of context management, driven by the stateless nature of AI. The course emphasizes: “The model sees only what is in its context window for this response. Your job is to control what goes in.”

Q34. In the Markdown In, HTML Out course, the principle “Markdown in, HTML out” is described as “just the most common pair of answers” to a deeper question. What is the deeper strategic principle being taught?

- A. A) Always use Markdown for everything
- B. B) Always use HTML for everything
- C. C) Choose the format based on who (or what) will read it last — person in browser = HTML, AI or future AI input = Markdown, social feed = plain text
- D. D) Format doesn’t matter

✓ Correct Answer: C) Choose the format based on who (or what) will read it last — person in browser = HTML, AI or future AI input = Markdown, social feed = plain text

Explanation: The course teaches the strategic principle: “who reads this last? If a person will read it in a browser, ask for HTML. If an AI will read it, or you will feed it back to an AI later, keep it in Markdown. If it is going into a social feed, plain text.”

Q35. The Code You Never Write course distinguishes between two uses of code — “toys” and “unglamorous chores.” What is the significance of this distinction?

- A. A) Toys are more important
- B. B) The course focuses on the practical, high-stakes work code was invented for — the real work with real consequences
- C. C) Chores are not worth automating
- D. D) Only toys can be built with AI

✓ Correct Answer: B) The course focuses on the practical, high-stakes work code was invented for — the real work with real consequences

Explanation: The course explicitly distinguishes: “This is the other half, and the bigger one, what code was invented for in the first place. Not toys, but the unglamorous chores that quietly eat whole days in real work, the kind with real stakes: a grade, a paycheck, a patient’s record, a client’s money.”

Q36. In the Code You Never Write course, what is the relationship between the user’s role and the code?

- A. A) The user must learn to write the code
- B. B) The user describes the problem; the AI picks the language, writes the code, runs it, and fixes it — the user never writes a line
- C. C) The user must review every line of code
- D. D) The user must know Python

✓ Correct Answer: B) The user describes the problem; the AI picks the language, writes the code, runs it, and fixes it — the user never writes a line

Explanation: “You describe the problem. The AI picks the language, writes the code, runs it, and fixes it. You never write a line, and you never read its syntax, though you will learn to check what it did.”

Q37. The Skills & Connectors course states that Skills are “portable: what you make here travels with you to every tool you use later.” What does this imply about the architecture of modern AI work?

- A. A) Skills are tied to one specific tool
- B. B) Skills are interoperable across different AI tools and platforms
- C. C) Skills cannot be transferred
- D. D) Skills are only for programmers

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Skills are interoperable across different AI tools and platforms**

Explanation: The portability of Skills means that the same Skill you create can work across different tools: “These plugins are portable: what you make here travels with you to every tool you use later, from this browser to desktop agents to the workers you may one day build.”

Q38. The Skills & Connectors course mentions that “automatic invocation” and “scope your access” are stable ideas despite UI changes. What principle does this reveal about working with AI?

- A. A) The UI is the most important thing
- B. B) The underlying concepts (teach once, connect apps, automatic invocation, scope access) are stable even as interfaces evolve
- C. C) Everything changes constantly
- D. D) Only programmers can keep up

✓ **Correct Answer: B) The underlying concepts (teach once, connect apps, automatic invocation, scope access) are stable even as interfaces evolve**

Explanation: The course advises: “The ideas (teach once, connect your apps, automatic invocation, scope your access) are stable. When a step doesn’t match what you see on screen, trust the screen and search the current docs.” This teaches that principles outlast UI details.

Q39. In the How to Think in the AI Era course, Person A and Person B have the same tools and same problem but different outcomes. What is the critical difference in their approach?

- A. A) Person A spends more time

- B. B) Person A forms her own opinion before asking AI and documents her reasoning; Person B lets AI's first answer become her opinion
- C. C) Person A uses a different AI tool
- D. D) Person A has a better internet connection

✓ **Correct Answer: B) Person A forms her own opinion before asking AI and documents her reasoning; Person B lets AI's first answer become her opinion**

Explanation: "Person A formed her own opinion before asking AI. Person B let AI's first answer become her opinion. That gap is what this crash course closes." Person A wrote down which AI claims she agreed with and what would make her change her mind.

Q40. The How to Think in the AI Era course states: "The deliverable is never the answer. The deliverable is the documented evidence of thinking." What is the full implication of this statement?

- A. A) Answers don't matter
- B. B) In the AI era, producing answers is no longer the hard part — the value is in the reasoning, evidence, and judgment that supports the answer
- C. C) Only documents matter
- D. D) AI cannot produce answers

✓ **Correct Answer: B) In the AI era, producing answers is no longer the hard part — the value is in the reasoning, evidence, and judgment that supports the answer**

Explanation: The course unpacks this: "First, the deliverable — the thing you hand to your boss, your professor, or your client — is no longer just the answer. AI can produce a polished answer in seconds; producing one is no longer the hard part. Second, what makes a [deliverable valuable is the documented evidence of thinking]."

Source: [The AI Agent Factory Foundations](#) • 40 MCQs • June 2026

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